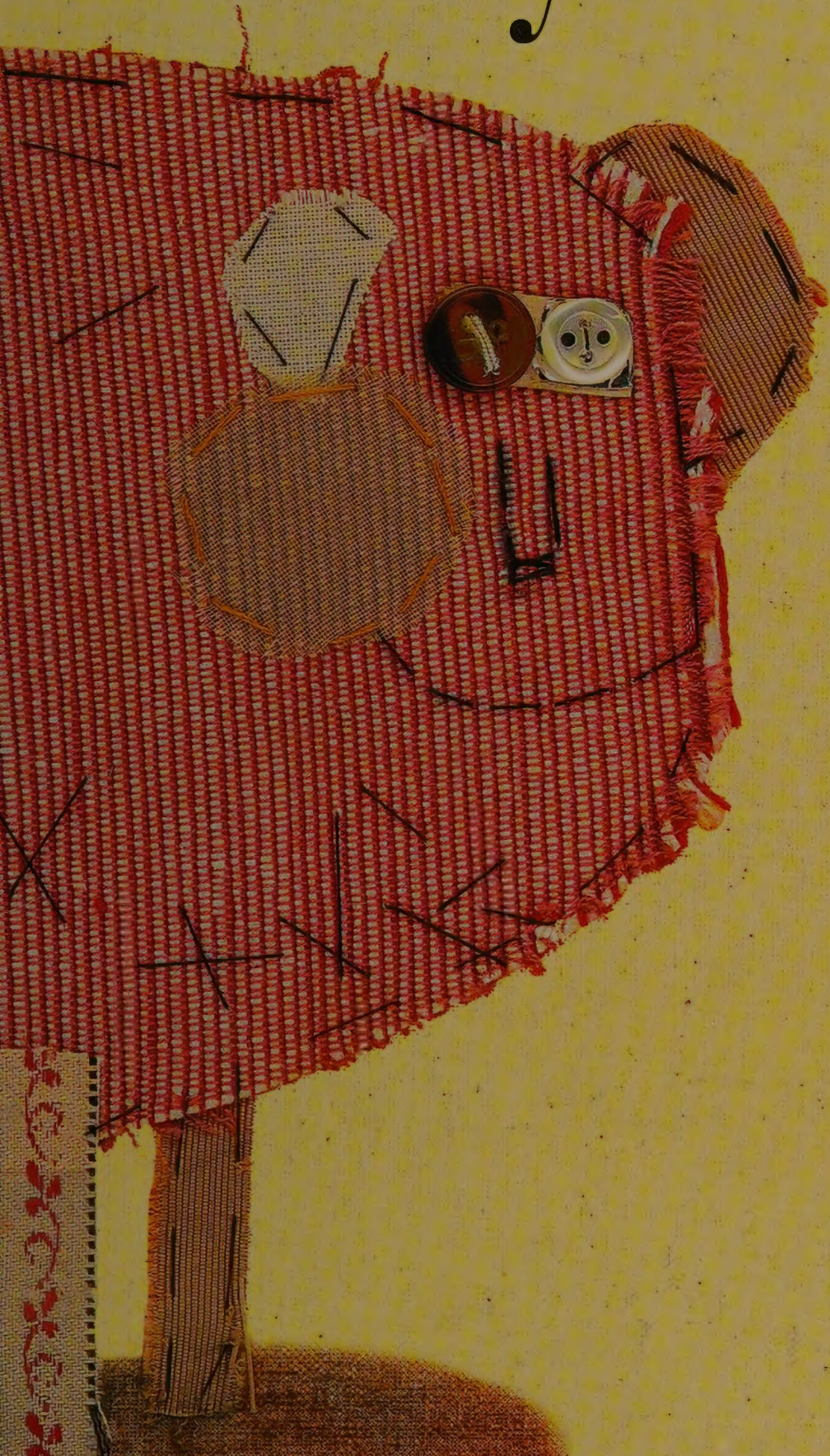


Beatrice Alemagna

My Friend



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For Rossella, Camilla, and Paola, for their friendship—B. A.

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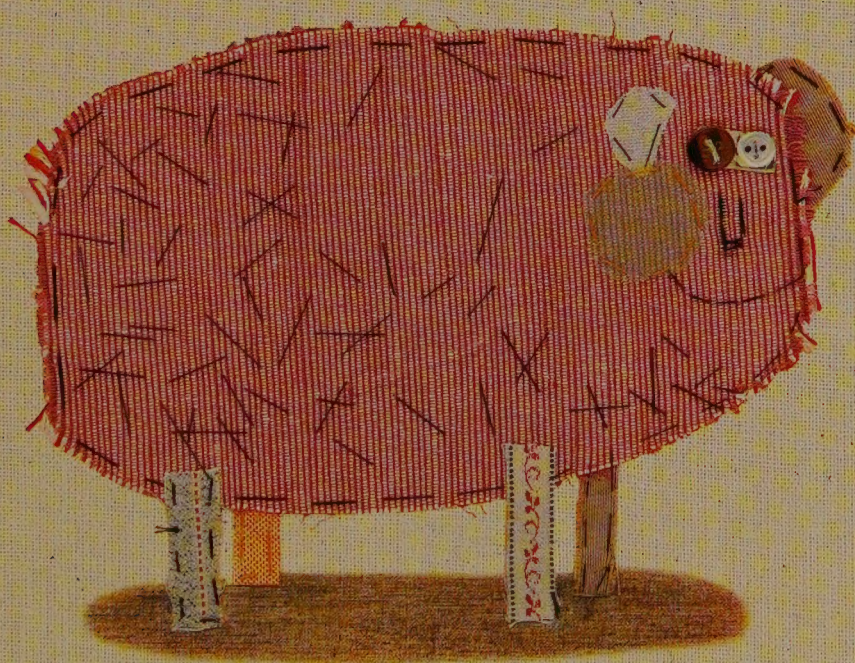
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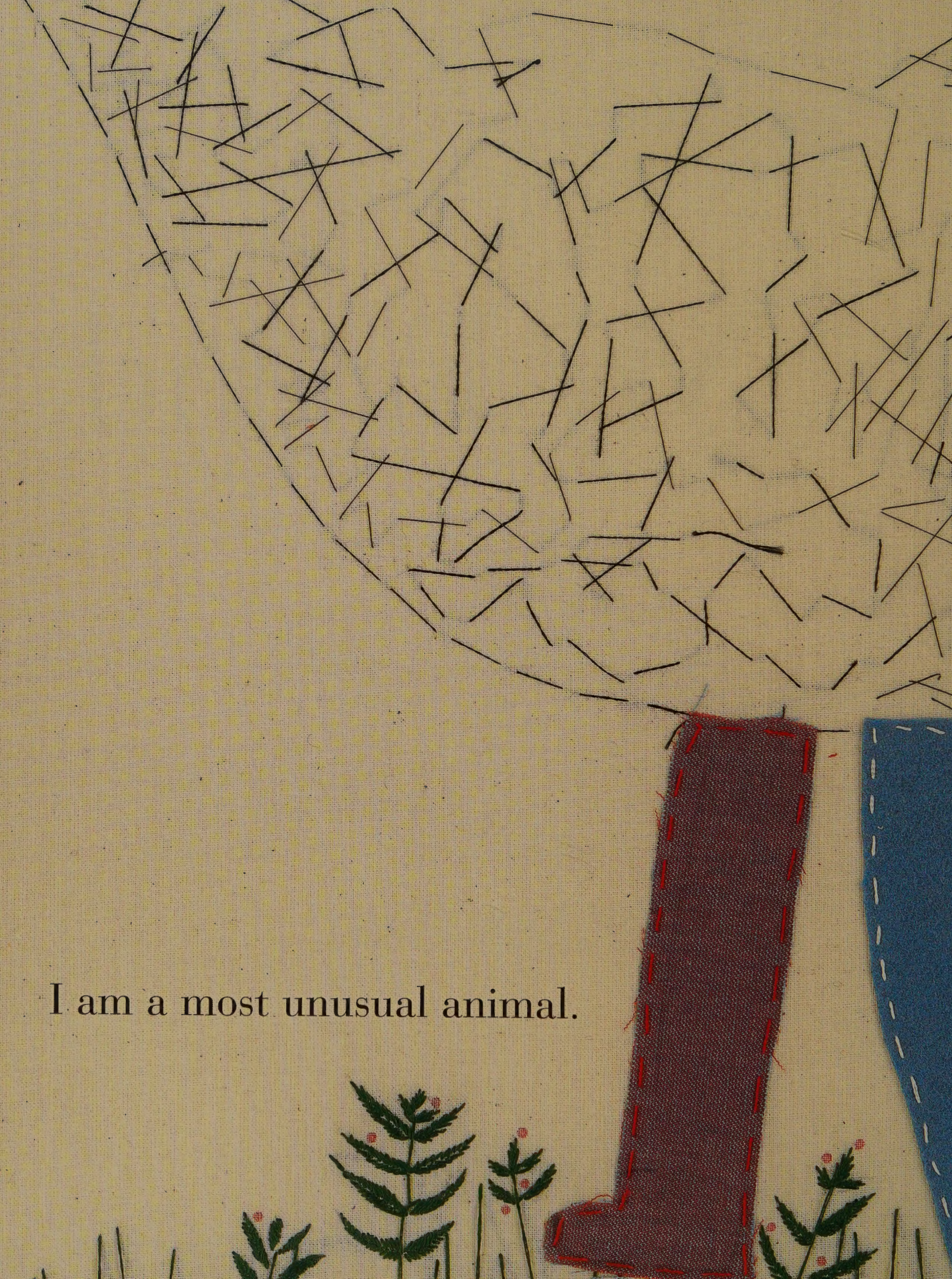
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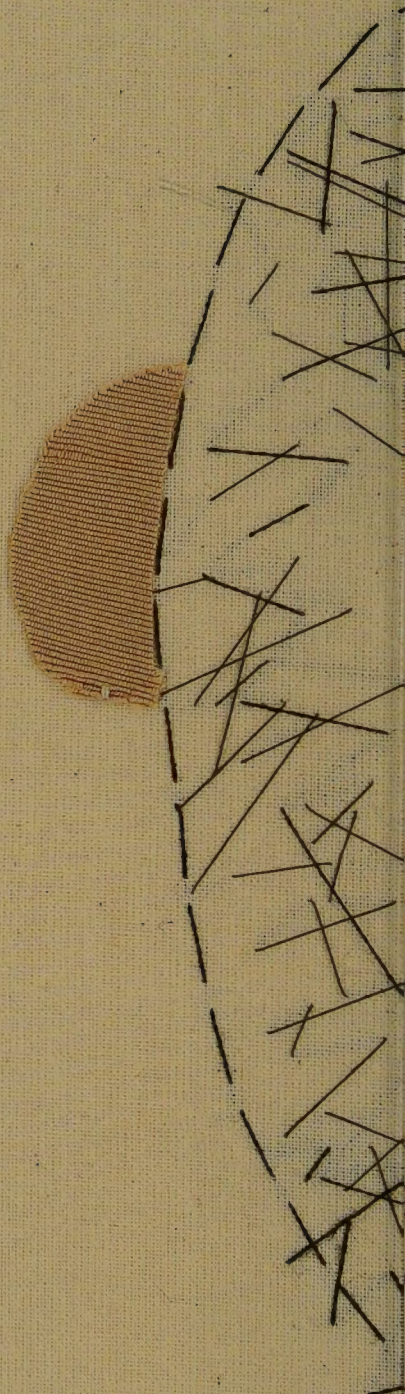
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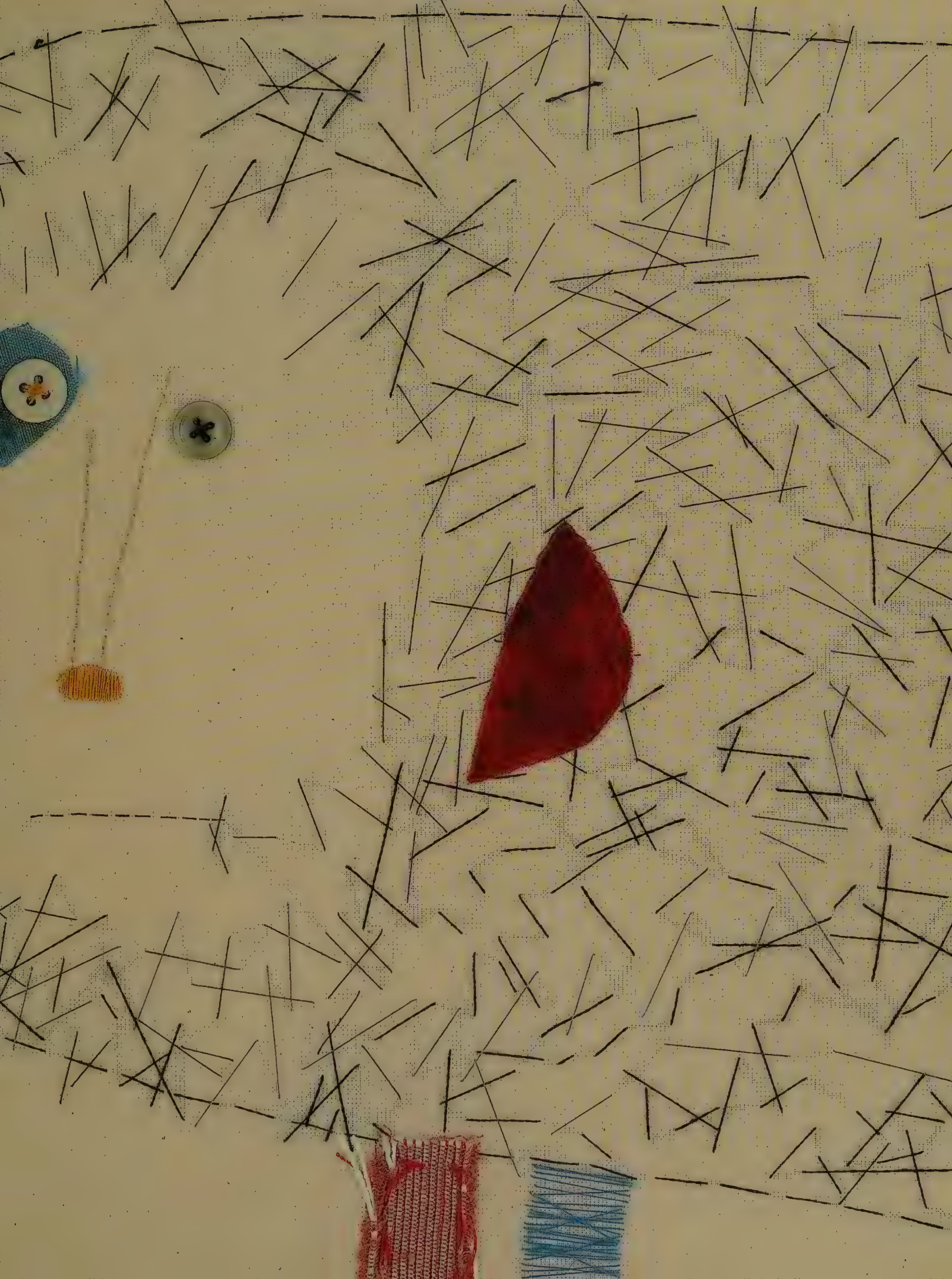


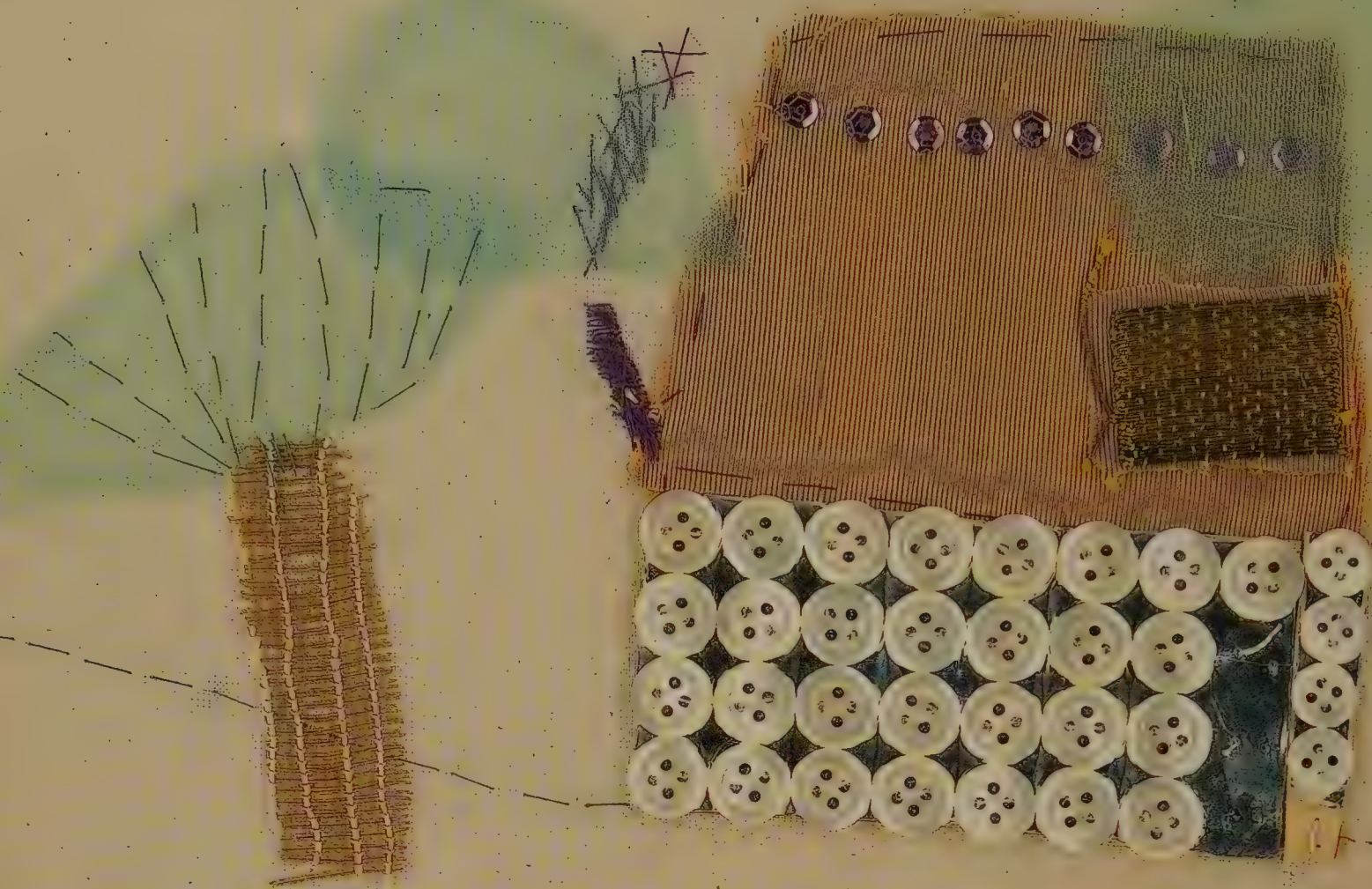
I am a most unusual animal.





I have fur like a dog and I'm shaped like a sheep.
But no one seems to know just what I am.





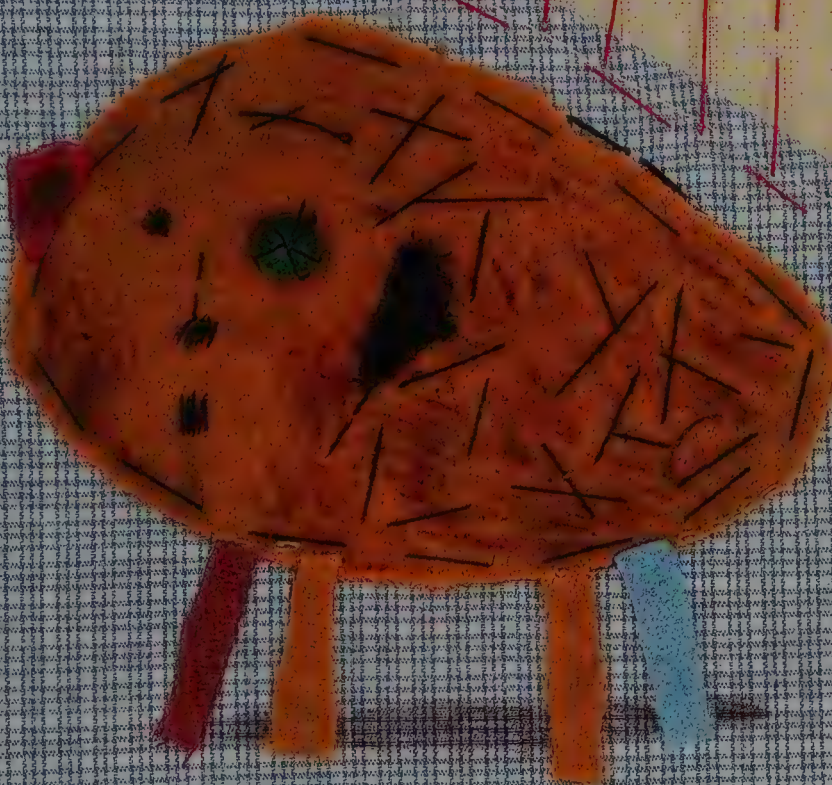
“Hello there, big cat, do you want
to hunt for mice?”

“I’m sorry, but I am not a cat.”



“Look at the funny monkey!”





"I am not a monkey."





“What are you? A rat?”



“Certainly not!”





“Are you a pigeon?”

“No, I’m not
a pigeon either.”

“You must be the lion
I was waiting for!”

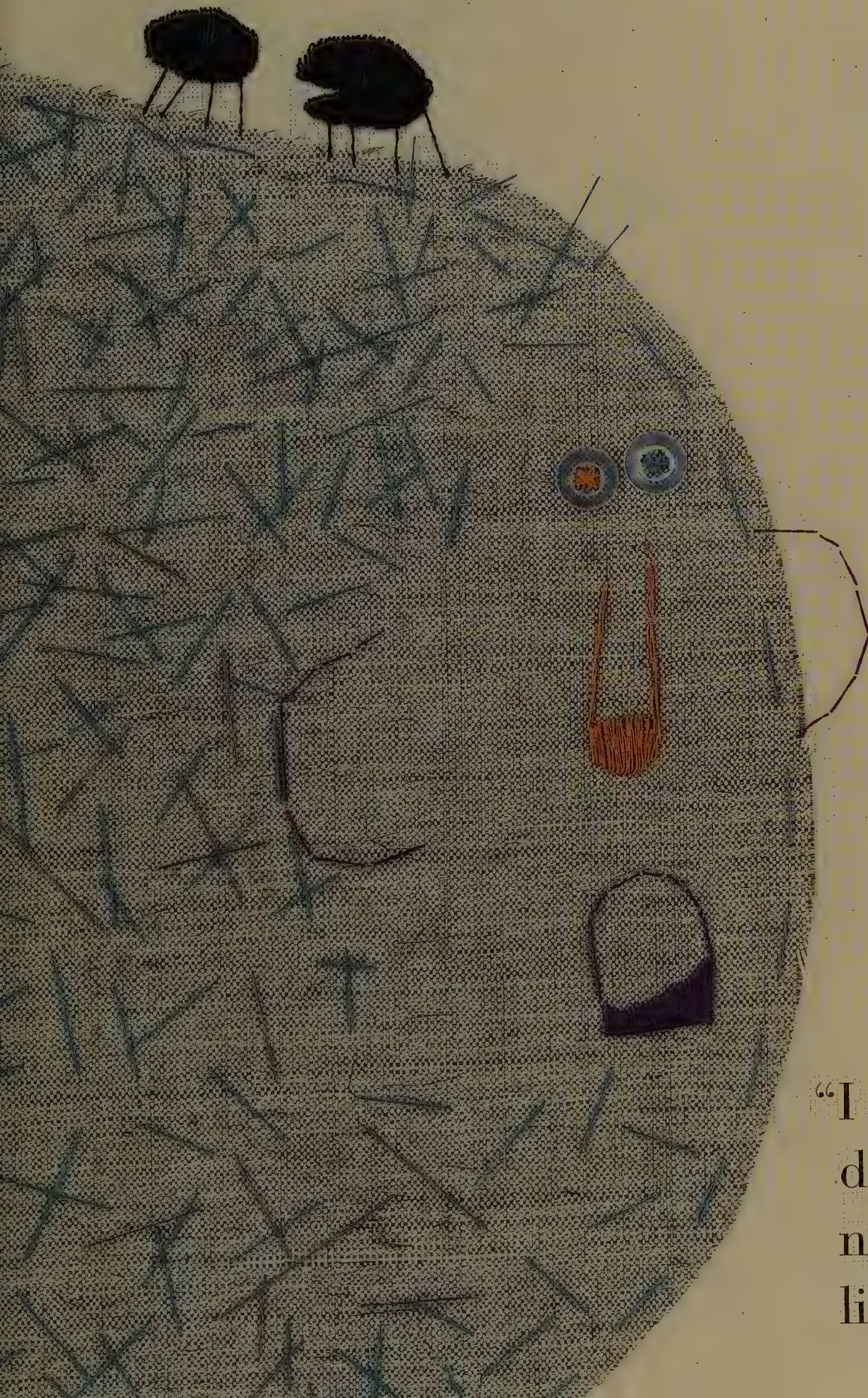
“I am not a lion, sir.”



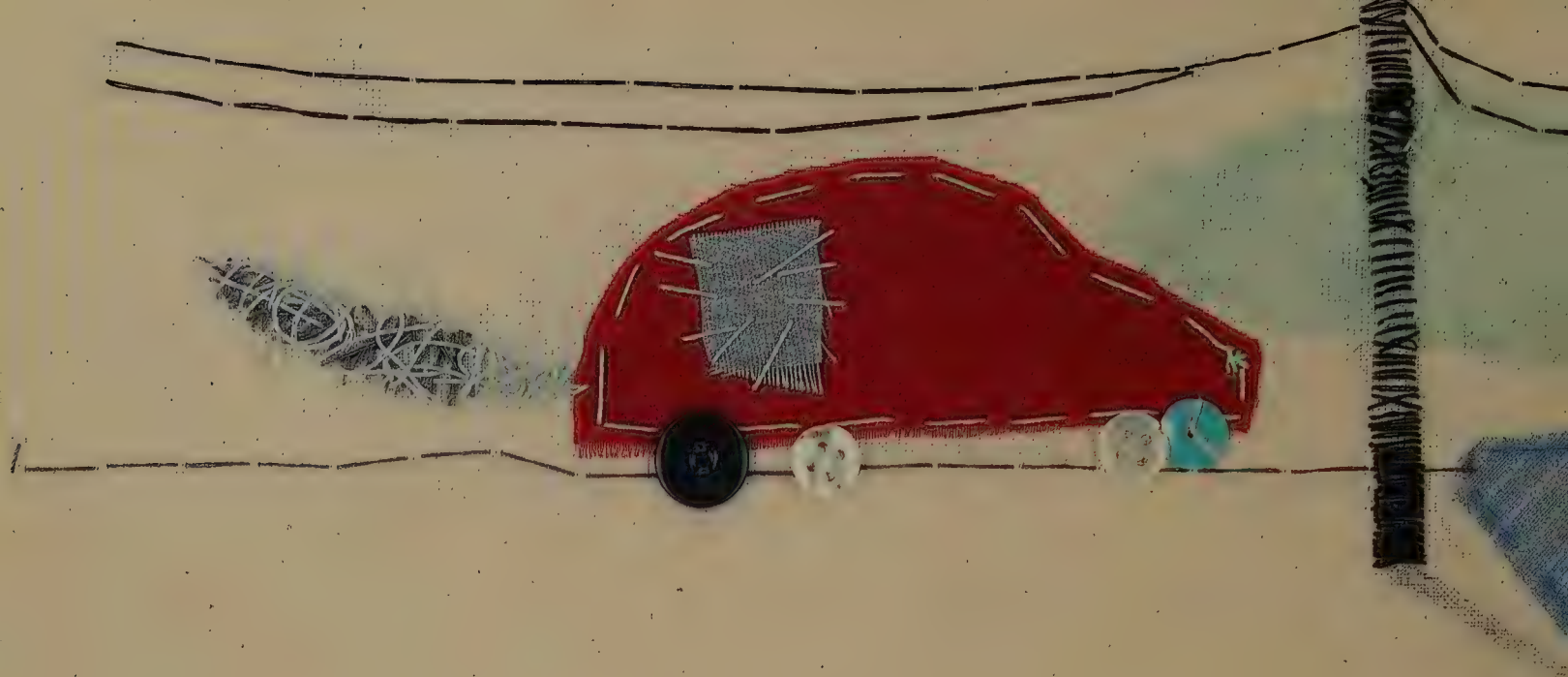




“Great! A furry dog to bite!”



“I am most definitely not a dog, little fleas!”



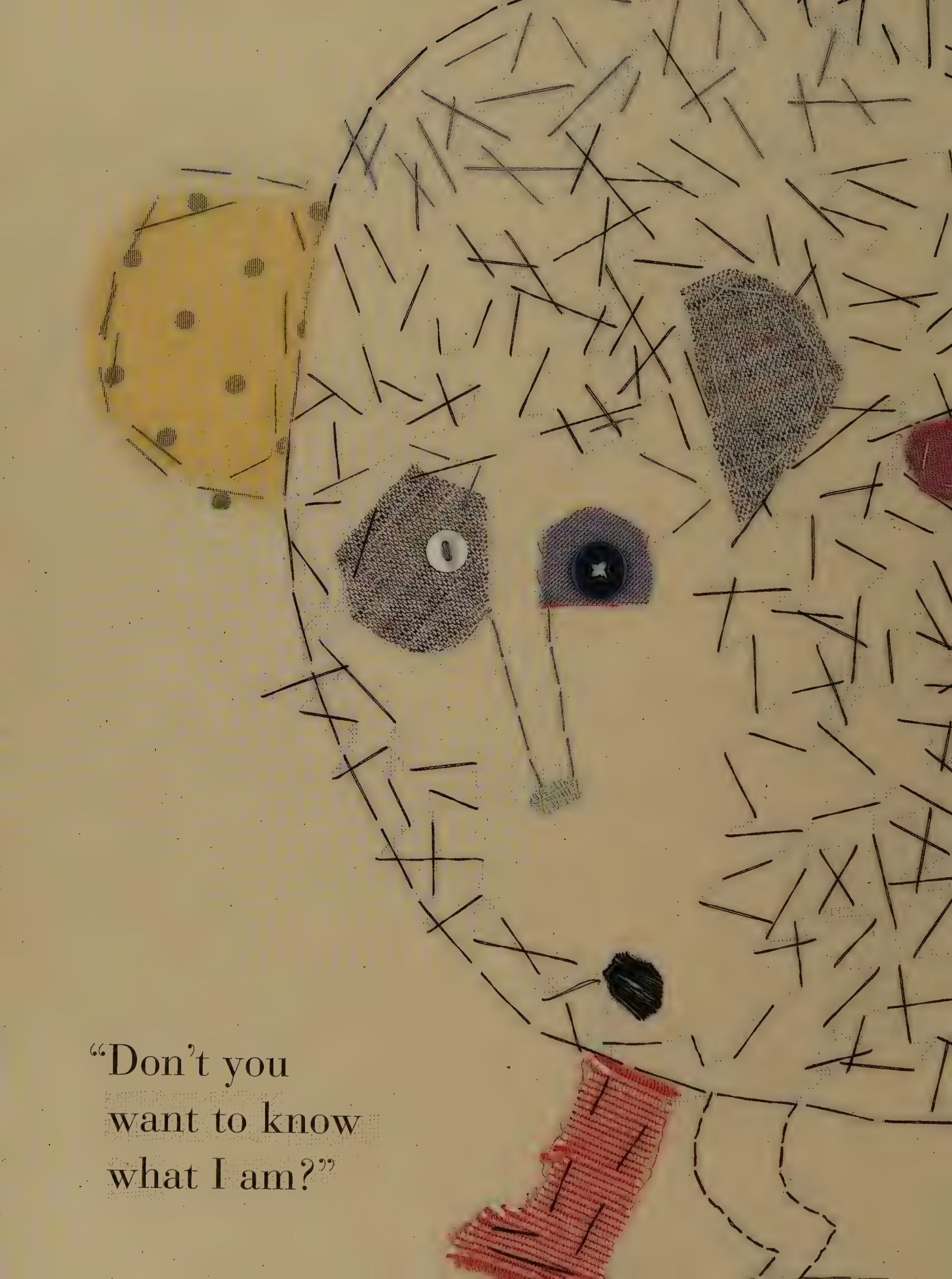
I am not a crocodile, nor a beaver.
I'm certainly not a hippopotamus.
I am not a mole, nor a wild boar.
But what am I?



“Hello. Do you want to play with me?”





A large, stylized face is formed by a dense arrangement of black stitching on a light-colored background. The face has a yellow patch on the left side with small dark dots. The eyes are made of grey fabric patches with white and black buttons. The nose is a small grey patch. The mouth is a black patch. The chin and neck area are made of red fabric patches. The background is filled with a pattern of black 'X' marks and lines.

“Don’t you
want to know
what I am?”





“I know what you are.”



You are my friend.”



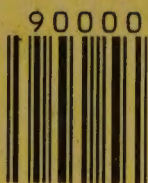
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